

Protecting Your Personal Data



Personal data is any information that can be used to identify you and it can exist both **offline** and **online**.

The difference between your offline and online identity.

Offline:

Your offline Identity is your real life persona that you present on a daily basis at home, at school or at work. As a result your family, friends know details about your personal identity, including your full name, age, address etc.

It's important not to overlook the importance of securing your offline identity. Identity thieves can steal your data right under your nose when you are not looking!

Online :

Your online identity is not just a name. It's who you are and how you present yourself to others online. It includes the username or alias you use for your online accounts, as well as the social identity you establish and portray on online communities and websites.

You should take care to limit the amount of personal information you reveal through online identity.

NOTE

Many people think that if they don't have any social media or online accounts set up, then they don't have an online identity.

This is not the case.

If you use the web, you have an online identity.